

Malta

Sovereign government data centre network — capacity, legal posture, provider landscape and migration path.

1 Starting point

Population	0.57 m
GDP	EUR 25 bn
Public administration (NACE O)	24 k
Electricity price	135.2 EUR/MWh
Renewables	10.7%
Live hyperscaler regions	0

2 What is structurally different

- Grid isolation. The national grid is an electrical island or nearly so (weak or single interconnection). The April 2025 Iberian blackout and Cyprus/Malta interconnector outages show the failure mode. Every site needs on-site generation and storage sized for multi-day ride-through, and the PUE and facility CAPEX assumptions should be revisited upward once site studies exist.
- Micro-state geography. The Dutch rule of 3-5 regions with 50-100 km separation cannot be met inside the national territory. The model therefore assumes two in-country sites carrying 55/45 of the load and no in-country reserve. A credible disaster-recovery posture requires an out-of-country partner site - deferred to the federation layer.
- No hyperscaler region in-country. Unlike the Netherlands, there is no commercial hyperscale tier to fall back on for non-critical workloads without leaving the jurisdiction. The sovereign core therefore has to be sized for a larger share of total government demand, and the hybrid model (Dutch GOAL.md section 7) needs a cross-border commercial tier.

3 Capacity

Servers	502 (CPU 338 / GPU 25 / storage 139)
IT critical load	0.8 MW
Facility design load	1.3 MW
Sites	2 (by capacity 1, floor 2)
Average per site	0.6 MW
Site count set by	the minimum-sites floor, not capacity
CAPEX	EUR 30 m
OPEX	EUR 3 m / yr

4 Proposed geography

Region	Role	Share	MW	Notes
Malta / Marsa - Santa Venera	Primary civil cloud	55%	0.7	MITA estate; Sicily cable landings.
Gozo	Sovereign secondary	45%	0.6	Only physical separation available (~30 km); shares the Sicily power/data corridor.

First-pass geographic hypotheses encoding only the obvious constraints, to be replaced by scored site selection.

5 Legal and regulatory posture

Governing instrument	National Digital Strategy 2022-2027; MITA operates central government IT
Cloud certification	No national scheme; ISO 27001
Data classification	Classified-information handling under national security legislation, aligned to EU/NATO markings
Procurement route	Department of Contracts

Foreign jurisdiction exposure. No in-country region; MITA runs a hybrid model with Azure for burst and SaaS

Under the US CLOUD Act and FISA 702 a provider subject to US jurisdiction can face a lawful order for data it holds regardless of where that data sits. Residency is necessary but not sufficient; what matters is who holds the keys and who can be compelled.

6 Current state and provider landscape

Government cloud	MITA Government Hybrid Cloud (MITA data centre + Azure); National Digital Strategy 2022-2027
Maturity	operational
Digital identity	Maltese eID (Identita) / MyIdentity
Interconnection	No major IXP (transits Sicily/Milan); Malta-Sicily cables and power interconnector

7 Migration path and cost

Phase	Scope	MW	CAPEX	Cumulative	Hybrid
1	Sovereign core	0.3	EUR 5 m	17%	no
2	Security and defense	0.5	EUR 12 m	58%	no
3	State record	0.2	EUR 6 m	77%	no
4	Elective	0.3	EUR 7 m	100%	no

Phase 1 is the number that matters: **EUR 5 m** for 0.3 MW, 17% of total CAPEX. That is the floor below which no hybrid arrangement helps — and it is a small fraction of the full build.

8 Geography and threat notes

Extreme land and water scarcity; single-corridor dependence on Sicily for both power and data (interconnector outages 2019, 2024 heat-wave blackouts); gas/LNG generation; low seismic (Etna proximity); low geopolitical risk